Session 5: Cold Calling & Multi-Channel

Sales 101 (Postgraduate) | The First Ten Seconds, and How Channels Work Together | 90 minutes

Class Agenda

Time	What we are doing	What you produce
0-04	Objectives and how you will know you got there	Nothing. Read the success criteria.
04-16	Why cold calling still works, and the four-part call structure	Notes.
16-24	The first ten seconds: the three things that end calls	Notes.
24-42	Workshop 1: write your script and your three objection responses	A call script.
42-70	Role-plays: three rounds, three different ways to get shut down	Three rounds of partner feedback.
70-83	Workshop 2: design a seven-touch multi-channel sequence	A sequence map.
83-90	Self-check and closing questions	Answer sheet, handed in.

Key Objectives

#	Objective	What success looks like	Where it is measured
LO1	Write a cold call script with an opener that is not 'How are you today?'	Your opener states who you are, why you are calling this person specifically, and asks for permission to continue, inside fifteen seconds.	Framework 1, Round 1.
LO2	Handle the three most common first-ten-second objections without freezing.	You get through all three rounds without going silent, reading from the page, or hanging up early. Your partner confirms it.	Role-plays, partner scoring.
LO3	Design a multi-touch sequence across email, LinkedIn and calls with specific timing.	Seven touches, each with a channel, a day, and a stated reason it differs from the touch before it. No two touches are interchangeable.	Framework 2.
LO4	Explain why channel sequencing matters	You can say what a call does that an email cannot, and what each channel earns you for the next one.	Framework 2 and the closing questions.

#	Objective	What success looks like	Where it is measured
	rather than blasting all three at once.		

SAME CASE AS SESSION 4

You are still selling Sprinto, and you should use the same target account you researched last session. Bring your research brief.

The point of continuity is that you will find out today whether that research holds up when you have eleven seconds instead of a paragraph.

Part 1: Why the Phone Still Works

Cold calling is the channel most people in this room will avoid for their entire careers, and the reason it still works is precisely that.

An email competes with two hundred other emails. A LinkedIn message competes with recruiters. A phone call competes with whatever the person was doing, which is a much harder fight for eleven seconds and a much easier one after that. It is the only channel where you find out today rather than never.

What a call does that an email cannot

- You get an answer. Silence on email is ambiguous. Silence on a call is a person who has already said no.
- You can adapt inside a sentence. If your opener lands wrong you know within three seconds and can change course.
- You can hear the real objection. People write polite objections and speak honest ones.
- It disqualifies fast. Ten calls tells you more about whether your trigger hypothesis is right than fifty emails.

The four-part structure

Part	Job	Time	What it sounds like
Opener	Say who you are and disarm the reflex to hang up. Ask permission.	10-15 sec	"This is a cold call. Can I have twenty seconds to tell you why I picked up the phone, and then you can decide?"
Bridge	Say why this person, not a list. This is your research, spoken.	10 sec	"I saw you're hiring your first enterprise AE."
Value	One sentence on the consequence you help with. Not the product.	10-15 sec	"The thing that usually surprises people at that point is the security questionnaire that arrives three weeks in."
Ask	One small, specific next step.	5 sec	"Worth a fifteen-minute call next week, or is this not a problem yet?"

THE PERMISSION OPENER

Naming the call for what it is disarms the reflex better than any attempt to disguise it.

"This is a cold call, do you want to hang up or give me twenty seconds?" works because it is honest, it is unusual, and it hands them control. Most people give you the twenty seconds.

The alternative — "how are you doing today?" — announces within four words that this is a sales call and that you are pretending it is not.

Part 2: The First Ten Seconds

Three things end calls. All three are reflexes rather than decisions, which is what makes them beatable.

What they say	What it actually means	What works	What does not
"Not interested."	Said before you finished your first sentence. They have not heard anything yet; this is a reflex to being interrupted.	Acknowledge and ask for a smaller thing. "Understood, you don't know what this is yet. Ten seconds and you can decide."	Continuing your script as though they did not speak. Arguing that they should be interested.
"Send me an email."	Usually a polite exit. Occasionally genuine. You cannot tell yet, so find out.	Agree, then ask one question so the email is worth sending. "Happy to. So I send something relevant rather than generic — are you being asked for SOC 2 yet?"	Saying thank you and hanging up. You have traded a live conversation for an email that will not be read.
Gatekeeper: "She's in a meeting."	A person doing their job. They are not an obstacle and treating them as one is both rude and ineffective.	Be straightforward and ask for help. "I'm probably calling at a bad time. When is she usually easiest to reach?"	Pretending you know her. Being evasive about why you are calling. Both get you blocked permanently.

Part 3: Workshop

Framework 1: Your Call Script

Eighteen minutes. Write it to be spoken. Read it aloud under your breath and time it: the whole thing should run under fifty seconds.

Case: XoxoDay -

Part	Your words	Seconds
Opener		

Part	Your words	Seconds
Bridge		
Value		
Ask		

Your three objection responses

They say	You say
"Not interested."	
"Send me an email."	
Gatekeeper: "She's in a meeting."	

Role-Plays: Three Rounds

Twenty-eight minutes. Pairs. Each round is a two-minute call, then ninety seconds of feedback, then switch. Your partner has a different instruction each round.

Round	The buyer's instruction	What is being tested
1	Say "not interested" within five seconds, before the caller finishes their first sentence. If they acknowledge it and ask for something smaller, give them fifteen seconds and then react honestly.	Whether the caller recovers or keeps reading.
2	Let them finish the opener, then say "just send me an email." If they ask a genuine question that would make the email better, answer it.	Whether the caller treats this as an exit or as a live conversation.
3	You are the gatekeeper. "She's in a meeting." Be polite and unhelpful unless they are straightforward with you, in which case help.	Whether the caller respects you or tries to get round you.

PARTNER FEEDBACK FORMAT

After each round, in this order, before any discussion:

"The moment you lost me was _____."

"The best thing you said was _____."

"You sounded like you were reading at _____." (or: you didn't.)

Quote the actual words. And be honest about the reading one — it is the most useful and the least comfortable.

Framework 2: Multi-Channel Sequence

Thirteen minutes, in pairs. Seven touches over roughly three weeks. Every touch needs a channel, a day, and a reason it is different from the one before it.

#	Day	Channel	What this touch does that the last one did not
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			
6			
7			

Two questions underneath

1. Which touch is the one most likely to get a reply, and why is it not touch 1?
2. What does the call earn you for the next email, and what does the email earn you for the next call?

WHY SEQUENCING BEATS BLASTING

Three touches on the same day is not three chances. It is one impression, and the impression is that you are automated.

Sequenced properly, each channel earns something for the next. A LinkedIn view makes your name familiar, so the email is opened. The email gives the call a reference point, so the opener is not cold. The call produces a real objection, so the next email can answer it.

The order is the strategy. The channels are just the tools.

Part 4: Check Your Own Learning

Objective	Check yourself	Tick
LO1: The opener	Time your full script aloud. Over sixty seconds and you will be interrupted before the Ask. Does your opener ask for permission, or assume it?	
LO2: Recovery	Ask your partner directly: in which round did I sound most like I was reading? Do not guess this yourself.	
LO3: Sequence design	Cover the days column. Could any two touches be swapped without anything breaking? If yes, one of them is not doing a job.	
LO4: Why order matters	Say out loud, in one sentence, what the call earns you that the email cannot. If you cannot, you have a list of channels rather than a sequence.	

THE MOST COMMON WAY TO FAIL THIS SESSION

You write an excellent script and then read it. The words are right and the delivery announces that you are working through a page.

A script is a structure to be internalised, not a text to be performed. If your partner can hear the punctuation, rewrite it shorter.

Closing Questions

Five multiple-choice questions in the last five minutes. Individually and silently.